

MAYBEWELL BOOKS



The Impossible Garden

Sixty prompts to draw the plants that don't exist

from the makers of Draw What You Imagine



A CREATIVITY BOOK

maybewellbooks.com



For you, who waters ideas to see what happens.

Before you plant anything

This is not a gardening book.

No real plant will grow from these pages. There are no watering schedules to follow, no Latin names to memorize, no rules about sunlight. Real botany is wonderful — but it's already been drawn.

This book is about the other garden. The one where flowers bloom for one minute a year, where seeds keep secrets, where trees walk at night and pretend they haven't.

Every page asks you to grow something that has never existed. Something only your pencil can plant.

Use anything that makes a mark. Draw huge or tiny, careful or wild. Nothing here can be overwatered.

There is only one rule:

If it can't exist, it belongs in this garden.

It doesn't matter if you've never drawn a leaf in your life. Impossible plants have no wrong shapes — that's the whole point of them.

This garden is yours. Plant it.

— *With love, Maybewell Books*

How to use this book

- Start anywhere. Gardens don't grow in order. Neither does this one.
 - Take your time. One seed a day, or a whole bed in an afternoon.
 - Nothing is a weed. Every stray line is just something new sprouting.
 - Replant freely. The same prompt grows a different plant every time.
-

Difficulty levels

- ★ ★ ★ Easy to imagine *Close your eyes and it's already sprouting.*
- ★ ★ ★ Requires some thought *Let the idea take root for a minute.*
- ★ ★ ★ Total challenge *For gardeners of the truly impossible.*

Start anywhere you like. Each prompt is its own world.

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Real botanists keep field notes.



Impossible Flowers

Every flower here breaks at least one rule of botany. Your job is to catch them doing it.

10 PROMPTS · #1 – #10

1

Draw the flower that blooms for exactly one minute a year. This is that minute.

Hint: Everyone who's ever seen it says something different.



2

A flower that grows facing away from the sun. What is it looking at instead?

Hint: Whatever it is, it must be worth it.



3

**Draw the flower that changes color
depending on who is smelling it.**

Hint: What color does it turn for you?



4

The last flower of a species nobody ever named. Draw its portrait so it isn't forgotten.

Hint: Portraits are formal. Give it its best angle.



5

A flower whose petals are tiny doors. Draw what's behind one of them.

Hint: Only one door is ever open at a time.



6

**Draw the flower that grows only where
someone laughed really hard.**

Hint: Its shape probably remembers the joke.





The flower bees tell stories about but have never found. Draw the legend.

Hint: Legends are always a little exaggerated.



8

A flower that wilts when you look at it directly. Draw it out of the corner of your eye.

Hint: Draw what you almost see.



9

Draw the flower that smells like a memory instead of a scent.

Hint: Which memory? That's the drawing.



10

The world's most stubborn flower grew somewhere it absolutely shouldn't. Draw where.

Hint: The less possible the spot, the prouder the flower.



2



Strange Seeds

Everything enormous starts as something tiny. These seeds just start stranger than most.

10 PROMPTS · #11 – #20

11

Draw the seed packet for a plant that doesn't exist yet. Front of the packet, please.

Hint: Real packets show the plant, the name, and planting instructions.



12

A seed that only sprouts if you whisper it a secret. Draw the moment of telling.

Hint: The seed keeps every secret. That's why it grows.



13

Draw what's inside a seed the moment before it decides what to become.

Hint: It could still be anything.



14

The wind carried this seed farther than any seed has ever gone. Draw where it landed.

Hint: Farther. No — even farther than that.



15

**Draw a sprout on its very first morning.
What does it see?**

Hint: Everything is enormous when you're a sprout.



16

**A seed that fell asleep for one hundred years
just woke up. Draw its face.**

Hint: Do plants have faces? Yours does.



17

Draw the seed that grows downward into a whole upside-down plant.

Hint: Where do its flowers bloom, then?



18

Somebody planted a button by mistake. Draw what grew.

Hint: The garden doesn't judge. It just grows.



19

Draw the instruction manual page for planting a star.

Hint: Diagrams help. Numbered steps optional.



20

A seed rattles when you shake it. Draw what's loose in there.

Hint: It's not another seed.



3



Trees With Secrets

Trees have been standing still for a very long time. They've had plenty of time to hide things.

10 PROMPTS · #21 – #30

21

Draw the tree that grows memories instead of fruit. Today it's your memories.

Hint: Which memory hangs from the highest branch?



22

**A tree with a door that only children can see.
Draw the door — you can still see it.**

Hint: Look closely at the handle.



23

Draw what a tree dreams about in winter.

Hint: Trees dream slowly. Draw a slow dream.



24

The oldest tree in the world keeps a diary in its rings. Draw one page.

Hint: One ring, one year, one entry.



25

Draw the tree that walks somewhere new every night and pretends it hasn't.

Hint: Its roots are terrible at acting casual.



26

A tree grew around something someone left leaning against it long ago. Draw them both.

Hint: The tree kept it safe all this time.



27

Draw the upside-down forest that grows beneath this one.

Hint: Every root down here is a branch down there.



28

The tree that catches falling stars in its branches. Draw tonight's catch.

Hint: Stars are lighter than they look.



29

Draw the treehouse a tree would build for itself.

Hint: What does a tree even want in a treehouse?



30

A lightning bolt struck this tree and now it glows from inside. Draw it at midnight.

Hint: The animals have opinions about this.





Gardens of Elsewhere

A garden is just a place where things grow. The place doesn't have to be possible.

10 PROMPTS · #31 – #40

31

Draw the garden that grows on the back of a very patient whale.

Hint: The whale gardens carefully. Slow turns only.



32

**A garden planted entirely inside a teacup.
Draw it at full bloom.**

Hint: Small gardens still need paths.



33

Draw the garden on the dark side of the moon. What blooms without sunlight?

Hint: Moonflowers are just the beginning.



34

The garden between the floorboards. Draw who tends it.

Hint: The gardener is exactly the right size.



35

Draw a garden where it's every season at once, one in each corner.

Hint: What grows on the borders where seasons meet?



36

A pirate buried treasure here and a garden grew from it. Draw what gold blooms into.

Hint: Coins make unusual seeds.



37

**Draw the garden that grows in the pause
between thunder and lightning.**

Hint: It only exists for a second. Make it count.



38

The library has a secret garden where stories are planted. Draw the story harvest.

Hint: Ripe stories are picked very gently.



39

Draw the tiny garden a snail carries on its shell, and the snail who's proud of it.

Hint: It's won awards. Snail awards.



40

**A garden grows in the reflection of the pond
but not beside it. Draw both sides.**

Hint: Only one of them is real. Or is it the other one?



5



Green Companions

No plant grows alone. These ones just keep unusual company.

10 PROMPTS · #41 – #50

41

Draw the plant and the creature that can't survive without each other.

Hint: Who helps whom? Draw the favor.



42

**A bee found a flower nobody has ever
pollinated. Draw the introduction.**

Hint: First meetings are awkward for everyone.



43

Draw the plant that adopted a lost bug and is raising it as a leaf.

Hint: The bug is trying its best.



44

The nightingale sings to one plant only. Draw the concert.

Hint: The plant has a favorite song.



45

Draw the plant that learned to purr from the cat that sleeps on it.

Hint: Where does a plant even keep a purr?



46

**A spider and a vine built something together.
Draw the collaboration.**

Hint: Half web, half garden.



47

Draw the flower that lets exactly one ant live inside, as a doorkeeper.

Hint: Uniform optional. Tiny hat encouraged.



48

The oldest turtle carries a seedling to the top of the mountain. Draw why.

Hint: Some plants can only grow where turtles decide.



49

Draw the plant that glows so its favorite moth can always find home.

Hint: Moths get lost easily. This one doesn't.



50

**Every bird in the forest brought one twig.
Draw what they grew together.**

Hint: It's not a nest. It's bigger than that.



6



The Gardener's Notebook

Real botanists keep field notes. So do impossible ones. This section is your notebook.

10 PROMPTS · #51 – #60

51

**Invent a plant and draw its field-guide page:
name, roots, leaves, and one warning.**

Hint: Every good field guide has one warning.



52

Draw the same impossible plant in spring, summer, autumn, and winter.

Hint: Four small drawings. One stubborn plant.



53

Draw the tool an impossible gardener would need, and label its parts.

Hint: It solves a problem no ordinary garden has.



54

A new plant was just discovered growing in your room. Draw the scientific sketch.

Hint: Note where it was found. Be precise.



55

Draw the map of your own impossible garden. Mark what grows where.

Hint: Every garden map needs a compass and a secret.



56

Write and draw the care instructions for a plant that cries when it's happy.

Hint: Watering schedule: complicated.



57

**Draw the cross-section of the strangest fruit
in your garden.**

Hint: The inside should surprise even you.



58

Design the greenhouse for plants that are afraid of the dark.

Hint: Glass, light, and one night-light. Or fifty.



59

Draw the prize ribbon ceremony at the Impossible Garden fair. Who won this year?

Hint: The judges are very serious about impossible vegetables.



60

Your garden's last page: draw the plant you'd grow if any plant were possible.

Hint: Any plant. Truly any. That one.





Out of pages?



Gardens don't end. They spread.

Go back to any seed and grow it completely differently.
Every plant you drew is the only one of its kind in the universe.
That makes you its habitat. Take care of it.

60

seeds

6

beds

∞

what grows

Grew something impossible? Share it with #TheImpossibleGarden — we want to walk through what you planted.



Printing tips

- Prints beautifully on standard Letter or A4 paper.
- Designed to be ink-friendly: activity pages use black and white with light accents.
- Print single pages again anytime — some plants deserve a second season.
- Thicker paper (120gsm+) works best for markers and paint.

Every page works in black & white — color is a bonus, never a requirement.

The Impossible Garden — Sixty prompts to draw the plants that don't exist
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Made for humans. For hands holding pencils, for gardens that need
no water, no sunlight, and no permission to grow.

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